

Max Dickson *Developer*

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Profile

I am a passionate Computer Science graduate with hands-on experience in full-stack development, focusing on creating dynamic web applications using React, Django, and PostgreSQL alongside experience in utilizing Agile methodologies to deliver products in a team environment. I am excited to bring my problem-solving skills and growth mindset to a dynamic tech team, and I am interested in building efficient, scalable solutions while continuing to expand my knowledge in cutting-edge technologies. References are available on request.

Work Experience

2024/10 – 2025/01 **Freelance Web Developer**

Christchurch (remote), *Fiverr*
NZ

I decided to start doing freelance work on Fiverr as a web developer in October while searching for employment. I decided to quit this role in mid-January as I found I was not making a stable income under it.

Christchurch (remote), **Tutor**
NZ *Self-employed*

I tutored high school graduates in Python programming over the summer so that they would have an easier time when the introductory courses in university began.

Christchurch, NZ **General Assistant**
Creative Junk

Aided in cleaning, packing, and unloading supplies for Creative Junk, a small arts and crafts store.

Education

Christchurch, **Bachelor of Science**

New Zealand *University of Canterbury* ☑

Major in Computer Science, Minor in Philosophy

Skills

Frontend

HTML/CSS(Tailwind), React(Next.js), UI/UX Design

Databases

MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL

Languages

C, C#, Command Line(Bash, Powershell), Python, Java, JavaScript(TypeScript), Prolog

Other

Compiler Design, Experience with DSA, Formal Languages, Knowledge of various Design Patterns, OS knowledge(Linux, Windows) Prototyping, Testing(Jest, Mockito), Usability Testing, User Research

Backend

Django, GraphQL, Node(Express), REST APIs

Tools

Agile (Kanban, Scrum), Cloud Computing (AWS), Docker, Git, Markdown, Notion, Obsidian, UML(Mermaid)

Professional Qualities

Excellent Written Communication Skills, Growth Mindset, Perseverant, Responsive Communicator, Self-paced Learner, Team Player

Projects

- 2024/11 – present **Research Blog** [🔗](#)
Django, Tailwind, AWS
An ongoing philosophical research project. I managed a blog to showcase original theoretical writings, serving as a platform for contributions from myself and peers to advance and share insights developed through the project. Currently on hold as we transition to a podcast instead.
- 2024/08 – 2024/09 **FoodFinder** [🔗](#)
Next.js, MongoDB, GraphQL, Jest, Docker, OAuth
A simple web app to help you find food fast!
A simple, proof-of-concept web app written using Next.js, MongoDB, and GraphQL, with additional testing via Jest and containerization handled with Docker. Makes use of OAuth to log users in via Github so that they can add a variety of restaurants to and from their wishlist. Jest is also used so as to evaluate the header via snapshotting, meanwhile GraphQL is used to allow the user to make the changes to their wishlist.
- 2024/07 – present **Personal Portfolio** [🔗](#)
HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Tailwind
A personal portfolio site that I started making as a means of advertising myself in a more stylish fashion, along with practicing UI/UX design further. Keep in mind this is something that is still very much in early stages, so some parts of it still look very "off". (currently down as I rewrite large chunks of it)
- 2024/03 – 2024/05 **Petition Site** [🔗](#)
TypeScript
A website for users to create and sign petitions. Written using Express for the backend, and React for the frontend. Received a mark of 86.30/100 for the backend implementation. Frontend implementation was a bit weaker, as it was complicated by ongoing personal struggles that required me to take leave, which as a result lead to me not being able to finish to the standard I desired.
- 2023/08 – 2023/10 **Fitness App Prototype**
User Research, Usability Testing, Prototyping, Cognitive Psychology
Worked in a six-person team designing a fitness app as part of the University of Canterbury's COSC368 course. This did not involve coding the app, but rather was based around prototyping and user evaluation, where we would work to deliver a final product that would be easy for the user to navigate. Designs are available on request.
- 2022/05 – 2022/06 **Language Compiler**
Python, Formal Languages, Compiler Design, Code Testing
I designed a language compiler in Python for a limited programming language as part of the University of Canterbury's COSC261 course. This compiler is comprised of a scanner, a parser, and a generator. I tested the compiler via writing custom programs, as a means of ensuring error-free functionality. This was unfortunately lost in a hard drive failure in early 2023 without any backup available, so I am unable to demonstrate it.
- 2023/04 – 2023/05 **Sports Tournament** [🔗](#)
Java
A single-player strategy game with a sports theme and an Oregon Trail inspired aesthetic that is written in Java. I worked closely with a peer in the creation of this.
- 2022/09 – 2022/10 **Paper-Scissors-Rock Microcontroller Game**
C
A paper-scissors-rock game written in C for use on a Funkit microcontroller for my Embedded Systems course in 2022. It's worth noting that the code for this was lost in a hard drive failure in early 2023, having forgotten to back it up, so I cannot prove this exists beyond that it is a required project for UC's ENCE260 course.